BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #31 · BRAIN INJURY AND MEMORY

"I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After a stroke, concussion, or other brain injury, abilities, personality, and speed can change. Family may say, "You're not the same," and the loss of who we were can feel like a loss of value.

What Scripture teaches

God's image in us is not tied to speed, memory, or skill: "God created man in His own image" (Genesis 1:27). "Even the very hairs of your head are all numbered" (Luke 12:7). "Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." "Your hands have made me and fashioned me" (Psalm 119:73). God knows you completely and loves you as you are now. Your worth was never your performance. You are still you, and still His.

> *"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them"* (Genesis 1:27).

Also see

> "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows" (Luke 12:7).

> "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day" (2 Corinthians 4:16).

> "Your hands have made me and fashioned me; give me understanding to learn Your commandments" (Psalm 119:73).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine!'" (Isaiah 43:1).

Common self-statements

- I am a shadow of myself.
- I am not me anymore.
- I have lost who I was.
- I am worth less now.
- Others miss the old me.
- I am a disappointment.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either who I was or nothing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be myself.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling changed and concluding I am less.
- Labeling: Calling myself less of a person.

Challenging questions

- What has changed, and what has stayed the same?
- What do my loved ones still love about me?

- What parts of my character remain, such as kindness, humor, and faith?
- What does Scripture say about the source of my worth?
- What new strengths or insights have developed?
- How can I grieve what has changed and still honor who I am?

Truth summary

> My worth rests in God's image and His love, not in my abilities. I may be changed, but I am not less. I can grieve losses and still live with purpose.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Suffering
- Sickness
- Grace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What has changed, and what has stayed the same?
- ☐ What do my loved ones still love about me?
- ☐ What parts of my character remain, such as kindness, humor, and faith?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about the source of my worth?
- ☐ What new strengths or insights have developed?
- ☐ How can I grieve what has changed and still honor who I am?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ God knows every hair on my head.
- ☐ My inner self is renewed.
- ☐ God made and fashioned me.
- ☐ My worth did not change.
- ☐ I am still me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ Luke 12:7
  "And even the very hairs of your head are all numbered. So do not be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Still me: Each week, note one thing that is still true of you.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Genesis 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am made in God's image, and my worth has not changed.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List constants. Write what has not changed.
- ☐ Grieve with a friend. Share what you miss.
- ☐ Ask loved ones. Hear what they treasure about you.
- ☐ Read Genesis 1:27. Remember God's image in you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still me
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm not the person I used to be, so I'm less of a person.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have changed and I mourn who I was. Remind me that my worth is in You, and help me live fully as the person You love now. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm stupid now."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Slower thinking, trouble finding words, and forgetfulness after injury or illness can feel humiliating, especially to those once quick and capable. Others' impatience can deepen shame.

What Scripture teaches

"The foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength" (1 Corinthians 1:25). "For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding" (Proverbs 2:6). "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple" (Psalm 119:130). Wisdom is more than speed: it includes humility, kindness, faith, and love. Your intelligence is one part of you, and it is not the source of your worth.

> *"For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding"* (Proverbs 2:6).

Also see

> "For the foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength" (1 Corinthians 1:25).

> "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple" (Psalm 119:130).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out" (Proverbs 18:15).

Common self-statements

- I cannot think anymore.
- I used to be smart.
- Everyone sees how slow I am.
- I am an embarrassment.
- I make mistakes all the time.
- I am dumb.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either smart or stupid.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always struggle.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling slow and concluding I am stupid.
- Labeling: Calling myself stupid.

Challenging questions

- What can I still do well?
- How has my thinking changed, and what helps?
- What strategies, like lists, routines, and extra time, help?

- What qualities of wisdom do I still have?
- What would I say to a friend who had the same injury?
- Whom can I ask for patience and help?

Truth summary

> I am not stupid. My thinking has changed, and I can use tools and patient help. Wisdom is a gift from God that includes more than speed. My worth is secure.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Wisdom
- Humility
- Suffering
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm stupid now"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm stupid now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can I still do well?
- ☐ How has my thinking changed, and what helps?
- ☐ What strategies, like lists, routines, and extra time, help?
- ☐ What qualities of wisdom do I still have?
- ☐ What would I say to a friend who had the same injury?
- ☐ Whom can I ask for patience and help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord gives wisdom.
- ☐ God's Word informs the simple.
- ☐ Wisdom is more than speed.
- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ I can use tools that help.
- ☐ I can ask for patience.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 2:6
  "For the LORD gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 1:25
  "For the foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength."
- ☐ Psalm 119:130
  "The unfolding of Your words gives light; it informs the simple."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Wise in other ways: Each week, note one thing you handled well.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 2:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord gives wisdom, and my worth is not my speed.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Use tools. Try lists, calendars, and reminders.
- [ ] Take your time. Ask for more time without apology.
- [ ] Name strengths. Write ten abilities that remain.
- [ ] Pray Proverbs 2:6. Ask God for wisdom.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm stupid now": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Wise in other ways
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm stupid now.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my mind feels slow. Give me wisdom, patience, and tools that help, and remind me that my worth is in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I'm losing my mind, and nothing can be done."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Noticing memory or thinking decline is frightening, especially when family history or a diagnosis is involved. Fear and hopelessness can lead to avoiding doctors, therapy, and support.

What Scripture teaches

"The Spirit helps us in our weakness." "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you." "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed." Some memory problems are treatable or manageable, such as those from sleep problems, medications, depression, thyroid, vitamin deficiencies, or stress, and even progressive conditions can be eased with support, safety planning, and care. Get evaluated. Nothing can be done is rarely the truth. Even if the mind fades, God's hold on you does not: "You hold my right hand" (Psalm 73:23).

> *"Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand"* (Psalm 73:23).

Also see

> "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).

> "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed" (Proverbs 15:22).

> "Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you" (Isaiah 46:4).

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- My mind is disappearing.
- There is no hope.
- It is only going to get worse.
- Why get tested?
- I cannot stop it.
- I will be a burden.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing my mind is either fine or gone.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rapid decline.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling afraid and concluding there is nothing to do.
- Catastrophizing: Calling myself hopeless.

Challenging questions

- What exactly have I noticed?
- Have I been evaluated by a doctor?
- What treatable causes could be checked?
- What helps me function better now?

- Who can help me plan and keep me safe?
- What does Scripture say about God's hold on me?

Truth summary

> I will get evaluated, use every help available, and plan with those I trust. Even if my mind changes, God's hold on me does not. Nothing is too hard for His care.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Sickness
- Trust
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm losing my mind, and nothing can be done"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm losing my mind, and nothing can be done." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly have I noticed?
- ☐ Have I been evaluated by a doctor?
- ☐ What treatable causes could be checked?
- ☐ What helps me function better now?
- ☐ Who can help me plan and keep me safe?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's hold on me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God holds my right hand.
- ☐ He cares for me.
- ☐ He will carry me.
- ☐ Many advisers bring success.
- ☐ There may be help available.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 73:23
  "Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand."
- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:22
  "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Seeking help: Each month, note one step taken: an appointment, a plan, or a conversation.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 73:23 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God holds my right hand.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Write what you notice. Note dates and examples.
- [ ] See your doctor. Ask about causes and tests.
- [ ] Involve family. Share your concerns.
- [ ] Use supports. Calendar, labels, routines.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm losing my mind, and nothing can be done": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Seeking help
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm losing my mind, and nothing can be done.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am afraid for my mind. Guide me to good care, give me peace, and hold me in Your hand whatever comes. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #34 · BRAIN INJURY AND MEMORY

“If I forget things, people will think less of me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Embarrassment about missing names, repeating stories, or losing track of the conversation can lead to avoiding gatherings or hiding the problem.

What Scripture teaches

“Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.” “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.” “The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable.” True friends value you more than your memory. Being honest about your difficulty often brings understanding and help, and makes it easier to enjoy company. God never forgets you: “I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands.”

> *“But the LORD said to Samuel, ‘Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.’”* (1 Samuel 16:7).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable” (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> “Behold, I have inscribed you on the palms of My hands; your walls are ever before Me” (Isaiah 49:16).

> “Therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, clothe yourselves with hearts of compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, and patience” (Colossians 3:12).

Common self-statements

- They will think I am senile.
- I am embarrassing.
- I have to hide it.
- I will lose respect.
- I should stay home.
- They are judging me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either respect me or think less of me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disrespect.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding I am judged.
- Mind reading: Calling myself an embarrassment.

Challenging questions

- What do my close friends say when I forget?
- What would I think of a friend who forgot a name?
- What could I say to put people at ease?

- What tools could help, like name tags, notes, or photos?
- What does God say about me?
- Which gatherings are most comfortable?

Truth summary

> My value to others and to God does not depend on my memory. I can be honest, use helpful tools, and enjoy people. God has not forgotten me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride
- Friendship
- Humility
- Anxiety/Worry

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I forget things, people will think less of me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I forget things, people will think less of me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do my close friends say when I forget?
- ☐ What would I think of a friend who forgot a name?
- ☐ What could I say to put people at ease?
- ☐ What tools could help, like name tags, notes, or photos?
- ☐ What does God say about me?
- ☐ Which gatherings are most comfortable?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ Weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ God has inscribed me on His hands.
- ☐ Honesty invites kindness.
- ☐ I can enjoy people.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] At ease with others: Each week, note one gathering you enjoyed.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Samuel 16:7 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord sees my heart, not my memory.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Prepare a phrase. Try, "My memory is slower now, so please be patient."
- [ ] Use tools. Notes, photos, calendar.
- [ ] Choose settings. Pick calm gatherings.
- [ ] Pray Isaiah 49:16. Remember God does not forget you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I forget things, people will think less of me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	At ease with others
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I forget things, people will think less of me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I forget and I am embarrassed. Thank You that You never forget me. Give me honest friends and ease with others. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

"I can't learn or grow anymore."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After injury or with age, we may stop trying new things because of earlier failures. The brain, however, retains the ability to adapt, and spiritual growth does not depend on speed or memory.

What Scripture teaches

"Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus." "Be transformed by the renewing of your mind." Spiritual growth in love, patience, and trust does not depend on IQ or memory. And the brain can often form new pathways with practice and rehabilitation. Growth may be slower, but it is real.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day"* (2 Corinthians 4:16).

Also see

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

> "The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out" (Proverbs 18:15).

Common self-statements

- My learning days are over.
- I am stuck where I am.
- New things are too hard.
- I will never improve.
- Therapy is pointless.
- I can only go backward.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing growth is either fast or impossible.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no improvement.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling stuck and concluding I cannot grow.
- Labeling: Calling myself stuck.

Challenging questions

- What have I learned or recovered since the injury?
- What small goal could I try?
- What therapists or programs could help?

- How have I grown spiritually through this?
- What does Scripture promise about God's work in me?
- Who can encourage me?

Truth summary

> Growth continues, though at a different pace. My inner self is renewed daily, and God will complete His work in me. I can learn in small steps.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Thinking, Healthy
- Faith
- Trust
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't learn or grow anymore"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't learn or grow anymore." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I learned or recovered since the injury?
- ☐ What small goal could I try?
- ☐ What therapists or programs could help?
- ☐ How have I grown spiritually through this?
- ☐ What does Scripture promise about God's work in me?
- ☐ Who can encourage me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ God will complete His work.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ I can grow spiritually.
- ☐ I am not stuck.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Philippians 1:6
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Small growth: Each week, note one thing you learned or improved.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 4:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will carry on His good work in me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Set a small goal. Choose one skill to practice.
- ☐ Ask about rehabilitation. Speak with your doctor.
- ☐ Celebrate progress. Write what improved.
- ☐ Read Philippians 1:6. Remember God is working.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't learn or grow anymore": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small growth
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't learn or grow anymore.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel stuck. Renew my mind, give me patience for small steps, and finish the work You began in me. Amen.

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